Dai-An Li

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Rm. 472, No. 1, Guanqian Rd., North Dist., Taichung, Taiwan

EDUCATION

M.S., Life Sciences 2024 – 2026

National Chung Hsing University Taichung, Taiwan

Thesis: Morphology, Bone Histology, and Systematics of East Asian Fossil Gavialids: Insights from *Penghusuchus pani* and the Zhuoshui Specimen from Taiwan

B.S., Double Major in Earth Sciences and Life Sciences 2021 – 2024

National Cheng Kung University Tainan, Taiwan

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research assistant 2026 – present

National Museum of Natural Science Taichung, Taiwan

Project Learning-Oriented Assistant 2024 – 2026

National Museum of Natural Science Taichung, Taiwan

Teaching Assistant for *Evolution and Paleobiology of the Dinosaurs* 2024

National Cheng Kung University Tainan, Taiwan

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Master's Thesis Research (Advisor: Dr. Tzu-Ruei Yang) 2024 – present

A New Crocodylian Fossil from Taiwan: Morphology and Taxonomy of a Skull from the Zhuoshui River (Collaborator: Dr. Masaya Iijima, Dr. Chih-Wei Chien)

Bone Histology Reveals Information on the Life History and Lifestyle of the Oldest Crocodylian Fossil from Taiwan (Collaborator: Dr. Nicole Klein)

Undergraduate Research Projects

How Old is "Gatao"? Insights from Frill Histology on the Growth Pattern of *Triceratops* (Advisor: Dr. Tzu-Ruei Yang) 2023

From Dinosaurs to Birds: A Study of Bone Cell Morphology and Stress (Advisor: Dr. Biqing Liang) 2022

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Graduate Student Overseas Conference Travel Grant 2025
National Science and Technology Council, Taiwan
For oral presentation at the Society of Vertebrate Paleontology 85th Annual Meeting

Professor Wu Sheng-Hai Memorial Scholarship 2024
Awarded for outstanding academic performance upon admission
National Chung Hsing University

Geological Engineers Association Fieldwork Scholarship, Second Prize 2023
Field Geology Survey Scholarship, National Cheng Kung University

Outstanding Oral Presentation Award 2023
Internship Research Presentation, National Synchrotron Radiation Research Center

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Dai-An Li, Chih-Wei Chien and Tzu-Ruei Yang. (2026) A new crocodylian fossil from Taiwan: Morphology and taxonomy of a skull from the Zhuoshuei River. *2026 Annual Meeting of Geological and Geophysical Society of Taiwan*, Taipei, Taiwan. (oral in Chinese)

Dai-An Li, Tzu-Ruei Yang and Nicole Klein. (2026) Bone histology reveals information on the growth history and lifestyle of the oldest crocodilian fossil from Taiwan. *36th Congress of Animal Behavior and Ecology*, Taipei, Taiwan. (oral in Chinese)

Dai-An Li, Tzu-Ruei Yang and Nicole Klein. (2025) Bone histology reveals the growth history and niche of the oldest crocodilian fossil from Taiwan. *85th Annual Meeting of the Society of Vertebrate Paleontology*, Birmingham, England. (oral)

Dai-An Li, Tzu-Ruei Yang and Nicole Klein. (2025) Bone histology insights into the growth history and niche of the oldest crocodilian fossil from Taiwan. *2025 Annual Meeting of Geological and Geophysical Society of Taiwan*, Taipei, Taiwan. (poster in Chinese)

Dai-An Li and Tzu-Ruei Yang. (2025) Bone histology and life history of the oldest crocodilian fossil from Taiwan. *5th Palaeontological Virtual Congress*, online. (oral)

INTERNSHIP

Projection X-ray Microscope and Transmission X-ray Microscope Aug. 2023

Summer Internship Hsinchu, Taiwan

National Synchrotron Radiation Research Center

Used Amira for 3D reconstruction and porosity analysis.

Operated transmission X-ray systems and performed basic instrument maintenance.

Geology Department Summer Internship Jul. 2022 – Aug. 2022

National Museum of Natural Science Taichung, Taiwan

Participated in Taiwan’s largest whale fossil excavation.
Assisted with fossil classification and collection cataloging.

SKILLS

Languages: Chinese (native), English (TOEFL iBT: 4.5/6.0; comparable to 90/120)

Computer skills: Microsoft Office, Amira, Blender, Photoshop, R, ImageJ, MorphoJ, TNT

Instrument Operation: μCT scanning, Transmission X ray Microscope (TXM)

Field Geological Survey: Constructing the geological history of an area, Determining the sedimentary depositional environment, Recording geological structure, Producing a geological map, Preliminary identification of minerals

Fossil Excavation: Removing the overburden, Fossil consolidation, Jacketing and preparation

Others: Petrographic thin-section preparation, Animal dissection, Car driver's license